Arabic Grammar for Understanding Quraan[1] Part V

Abu Raihan Mostofa Kamal

Professor, CSE Department
Islamic University of Technology (IUT)
Gazipur-1704 Bangladesh
raihan.kamal@iut-dhaka.edu
+8801843925543

February 11, 2025

[1] This tutorial has been prepared primarily from NAK Dreamprogram and other Textbooks

Chapter Outline

Negation in Verbal Sentence

Negation in Noun-based Sentence

Absolute Negation

Negation to Affirm

Negation in Verbal Sentence or الْجُمْلَةُ الفِعْلِيَّةُ

In this section we will learn the tools and techniques for Negation for each Tense separately.

i. Past Tense
ii. Present Tense
iii. Future Tense

Negation in Past Tense

There are 2 options for negation in past tense, using two particles

i. Normal past tense ⟵ مَا
ii. Lightest version of present tense ⟵ لَمْ

Example:

Affirmative	نَصَرَ He helped

(i) Negation Option 1	مَا نَصَرَ **He did not help**
(ii) Negation Option 2	لَمْ يَنْصُرْ **He did not help**

Negation in Past Tense Cont.

- But there is **difference** between these two options:

(i) Negation Option 1	مَا نَصَرَ **He did not help at all**	Stronger than option (ii)
(ii) Negation Option 2	لَمْ يَنْصُرْ **He did not help**	General form

Negation in Past Tense: Example

مَا ضَلَّ صَاحِبُكُمْ وَ مَا غَوَىٰ ﴿٢﴾

Your fellow man (i.e. Prophet Muhammad) has not been (by no means) **misguided nor he has gone astray**. (53:2)

قَالُوا آمَنَّا بِأَفْوَاهِهِمْ وَ لَمْ تُؤْمِنْ قُلُوبُهُمْ

They said with their mouth "We believe", but their hearts **did not believe**. (5:41 part)

Negation in Present Tense

- There are 2 options for negating present tense sentence. Although in Arabic present tense also covers future, but in this context present does not include future tense. As there are tools specific to future negation.

  Options:

Option	Example	Remarks
(i) Normal Present + مَا	مَا يَنْصُرُ He does not help at all	Stronger than option (ii)
(ii) Normal Present + لَا	لَا يَنْصُرُ He does not help	General form

Negation in Future Tense

- There are 2 options for negating future tense sentence in Arabic.
  Options:

Option	Example	Remarks
(i) Present Light + لَنْ	لَنْ يَنْصُرَ He will not help	General way
(ii) Present Lightest + لَمَّا	لَمَّا يَنْصُرْ He has not helped yet	Present Perfect Tense

Negation in Future: Examples from Quran

وَ لَنْ تَفْعَلُوا فَ ٱتَّقُوا ٱلنَّارَ

and **you will never be able to do**–then fear the fire.. (2:24 part)

وَ لَمَّا يَدْخُلِ ٱلْإِيمَٰنُ فِي قُلُوبِكُمْ

and faith **has not yet entered** your heart... (49:14 part)

- Note for 49:14: The actual word-by-word would be لَمَّا يَدْخُلْ where the verb takes its **lightest** form **but** in order **to join the next word** a kasrah ـِ is used.
- Other point for 49:14: Here the **ٱلْإِيمَٰنُ** is the **Outside Doer**.

Negation in Noun-based Sentence or الْجُمْلَةُ الاسْمِيَّة

Follow the steps:

i. Add مَا in the beginning.

ii. Keep the مُبتَدَأْ (i.e. Early Subject) unchanged.

iii. Turn the خَبَرْ (i.e. Late Subject) into مَنْصُوبٌ
alternatively, add بِ and **change its status accordingly** (for extra emphasis).
Recall بِ is one of the Harf of Jarr.

Negation in Noun-based Sentence or الْجُمْلَةُ الاسْمِيَّة Example

- Lets consider the following simple example:

Affirmative	ٱلْمُسْلِمُ صَالِحٌ The Muslim is good

- Note, here ٱلْمُسْلِمُ is the **مُبْتَدَأْ** or **Early Subject** while صَالِحٌ is the **خَبَرْ** or **Late Subject**

(i) Option 1	مَا ٱلْمُسْلِمُ صَالِحًا **The Muslim is not good**	General way
(ii) Option 2	مَا ٱلْمُسْلِمُ بِصَالِحٍ **The Muslim is not good at all**	Stronger Version

Negation in Noun-based Sentence or الْجُمْلَةُ الاسْمِيَّة Example Cont.

- Similarly,

(i) Option 1	مَا ٱللَّهُ غَافِلًا Allah is not unaware	General way
(ii) Option 2	مَا ٱللَّهُ بِغَافِلٍ Allah is not unaware by any means	Stronger Version

Negation in Noun-based Sentence or الْجُمْلَةُ الاسْمِيَّة The 3rd Option

- So far, we have seen 2 options for Negation of Noun-based Sentence or الْجُمْلَةُ الاسْمِيَّة i.e. using مَا only or using مَا and بِ together.
- Instead of مَا particle, there is another option, using لَيْسَ **particle**. It is used in place of مَا
- لَيْسَ **particle** is used **always** in **Present Tense**.
- But it is not exactly used as مَا where it is not changed at all. Unlike مَا, لَيْسَ is used like present tense يَنْصُرُ from its Chart.

لَيْسَ Chart[1]

هُمْ لَيْسُوْا They are not...	هُما لَيْسا Both of them are not...	هُوَ لَيْسَ He is not...
هُنَّ لَسْنَ They are not...	هُما لَيْسَتا Both of them are not...	هِيَ لَيْسَتْ She is not...
أَنْتُمْ لَسْتُمْ All of you are not...	أَنْتُما لَسْتُما You two are not...	أَنْتَ لَسْتَ You are not...
أَنْتُنَّ لَسْتُنَّ All of you are not...	أَنْتُما لَسْتُما You two are not...	أَنْتِ لَسْتِ You are not...
نَحْنُ لَسْنا We are not...		أَنا لَسْتُ I am not...

[1] Dream Text Book Page No. 124

لَيْسَ Example

- Lets consider the following simple example:

Affirmative	ٱلْمُسْلِمُ صَالِحٌ The Muslim is good

- Observe the Option 3(a) and 3(b). Just replace مَا with لَيْسَ

(i) Option 1	مَا ٱلْمُسْلِمُ صَالِحًا **The Muslim is not good**	General way
(ii) Option 2	مَا ٱلْمُسْلِمُ بِصَالِحٍ **The Muslim is not good at all**	Stronger Version
(i) Option 3(a)	لَيْسَ ٱلْمُسْلِمُ صَالِحًا **The Muslim is not good**	General way
(ii) Option 3(b)	لَيْسَ ٱلْمُسْلِمُ بِصَالِحٍ **The Muslim is not good at all**	Stronger Version

مَا and لَيْسَ Example

- Lets consider the following simple example:

Affirmative	هُمْ مِنَ ٱلْخَاسِرِينَ They are from the losers

- Note that in both مَا with ب لَيْسَ version is not applicable here. Because,ب is added only with خَبَرْ . In the given sentence there is no خَبَرْ . Here هُمْ is the مُبتَدَأْ while مِنَ ٱلْخَاسِرِينَ is the مُتَعَلِّق بِا لخَبرَ

(i) Option 1	مَا هُمْ مِنَ ٱلْخَاسِرِينَ They are not from the losers	–
(ii) Option 3(a)	لَيْسُوا مِنَ ٱلْخَاسِرِينَ They are not from the losers	–

Examples from the Quran

مِن وَّرَآءِهِي جَهَنَّمُ وَ يُسْقَىٰ مِن مَّآءٍ صَدِيدٍ﴿١٦﴾ يَتَجَرَّعُهُو وَ لَا يَكَادُ يُسِيغُهُو وَ يَأْتِيهِ ٱلْمَوْتُ مِنْ كُلِّ مَكَانٍ وَّ مَا هُوَ بِمَيِّتٍ ۖ وَ مِن وَّرَآءِهِي عَذَابٌ غَلِيظٌ ﴿١٧﴾

Before him is Hell, and he **will be given** a drink of purulent water(16). He will gulp it but will hardly [be able to] swallow it. And death will come to him from everywhere, but **he is not to die (in any way)**. And before him is a massive punishment (17). (14:16–17)

Absolute Negation

- **Absolute Categorical Negation** is another type of negation that is unique to الْجُمْلَةُ الاسْمِيَّة
- It reflects the meaning **"there is absolutely no...(without any exception)"**
- It is formed by:

جَارٌ مَجْرُوْرٌ	إِسْم (مَنْصُوبٌ and Light)	لَا

Absolute Negation: Examples

Rule	جَارٌ مَجْرُوْرٌ	إِسْم (مَنْصُوبٌ and Light)	لَا
Examples	فِي ٱلدِّينِ	إِكْرَاهَ	لَا
	There is **absolutely** no compulsion in religion		
	لَهُ	شَرِيكَ	لَا
	He has **absolutely** no partner		
	فِهِ	رَيْبَ	لَا
	There is **absolutely** no doubt in it		

Absolute Negation: Exception

- Recall: For Absolute Negation the إِسْم must be both مَنْصُوبٌ and Light.
- But for **General Negation** (where exception may be made) the إِسْم is مَرْفُوعٌ and **Heavy**.

Rule	جَارٌ مَجْرُوْرٌ	إِسْم (مَرْفُوعٌ and **Heavy**)	لَا
Examples	فِيهِ	بَيْعٌ	لَا
	There is no sale in it		
	فِيهِ	شَفَا عَةٌ	لَا
	There is no intersession in it		

- In both examples, exception may be made.

Negation used to Affirm Strongly[1]

- Negation under this segment– reflects the meaning of **"Nothing but.."** to strongly affirm the fact.
- **Pattern:** مَا + إِلَّا or إِنْ + إِلَّا
- Both patterns are used for refutation (someones claim) but إِنْ + إِلَّا is more **emphatic and powerful**.
- Patterns can be applied in **both types** of sentences i.e. الْجُمْلَةُ الاسْمِيَّة and الْجُمْلَةُ الفِعْلِيَّةُ

[1] Dream Text Book Section 9.4, page 126

Negation used to Affirm Strongly: Examples

- Lets consider the following simple example:

Normal version	هُوَ رَسُولٌ He is a messenger

- Lets look into <u>two versions</u> of emphatic sentences:

(i) مَا + إِلَّا	مَا هُوَ إِلَّا رَسُولٌ **He is nothing but a messenger**	Emphatic
(ii) إِنْ + إِلَّا	إِنْ هُوَ إِلَّا رَسُولٌ **He is nothing but a messenger**	More emphatic

Negation used to Affirm Strongly: More Examples

- Lets consider another example:

Normal version	هُوَ ذِكْرٌ It is a reminder

- Lets look into <u>two versions</u> of emphatic sentences:

(i) مَا + إِلَّا	مَا هُوَ إِلَّا ذِكْرٌ **It is nothing but a reminder**	Emphatic
(ii) إِنْ + إِلَّا	إِنْ هُوَ إِلَّا ذِكْرٌ **It is nothing but a reminder**	More emphatic

Negation used to Affirm Strongly: More Examples

- Lets consider another example:

Normal version	أَنْتُمْ بَشَرٌ You are a man

- Lets look into <u>two versions</u> of emphatic sentences:

(i) مَا + إِلَّا	مَا أَنْتُمْ إِلَّا بَشَرٌ **You are nothing but a man**	Emphatic
(ii) إِنْ + إِلَّا	إِنْ أَنْتُمْ إِلَّا بَشَرٌ **You are nothing but a man**	More emphatic

Negation to Affirm: Example from Quran

- Emphatic patterns: إِنْ + إِلَّا or مَا + إِلَّا
- In the following ayah the criminals confessed their guilt and they said that the warners were greatly misguided.

قَالُو بَلَىٰ قَدْ جَآءَنَا نَذِرٌ فَكَذَّبْنَا وَ قُلْنَا مَا نَزَّلَ ٱللَّهُ مِنْ شَيْءٍ إِنْ أَنْتُمْ إِلَّا فِي ضَلَٰلٍ كَبِيرٍ ﴿٩﴾

They will reply, "Yes, a warner did come to us, but we did not believe him. We said, Allah has revealed nothing: you are **greatly** misguided." (Sura Mulk 67:9)

Negation to Affirm: More Example from Quran

- Emphatic patterns: إِلَّا + إِنْ or إِلَّا + مَا
- In the following ayah Allah says, the Quran is **nothing but i.e. must be** reminder for the entire creation (having intellect).

إِنْ هُوَ إِلَّا ذِكْرٌ لِّلْعٰلَمِينَ ﴿٨٧﴾

This is **only but i.e. undoubtedly** a warning for all people. (Sad 38:87)

Negation to Affirm: For Verbal Sentence الْجُمْلَةُ الفِعْلِيَّةُ

- So far, all presented examples were Noun-based Sentence الْجُمْلَةُ الاسْمِيَّة but the same patterns can be applied to any Verbal Sentence الْجُمْلَةُ الفِعْلِيَّةُ .
- Lets consider the following example:

Normal version	يَكْلُونَ كَذِبًا They say a lie

- Lets look into two versions of emphatic sentences:

(i) مَا + إِلَّا	مَا يَكْلُونَ إِلَّا كَذِبًا They say nothing but a lie	Emphatic
(ii) إِنْ + إِلَّا	إِن يَّكْلُونَ إِلَّا كَذِبًا They say nothing but a lie 18:5 part	More emphatic

Extra/Additional مِنْ

- This extra مِنْ can be attached to an إِسْمٌ or a fragment without changing its role in the sentence, but **adds a new shade of meaning**. Here it adds the meaning of **not a single or any**.

3 conditions for additional مِنْ :

i. Will always come in either a NEGATED SENTENCE or a QUESTIONING SENTENCE.
ii. The WORD FOLLOWING it will always be COMMON نَكِرَةٌ
iii. The sentence should still make sense after its removal.

Extra/Additional مِنْ: Examples

With مِنْ i.e. Emphatic Version	Without مِنْ i.e. Normal Version
مَا لَهُ مِنْ قَلَمٍ He doesn't have a single pen	مَا لَهُ قَلَمٌ He doesn't have a pen
مَا فِي ٱلْبَيْتِ مِنْ رَجُلٍ There isn't a single man in the house	مَا فِي ٱلْبَيْتِ رَجُلٌ There is no man in the house
مَا تَسْقُطُ مِنْ وَرَقَةٍ Not a single leaf falls	مَا تَسْقُطُ وَرَقَةٌ No leaf falls

Extra/Additional مِنْ: Important Note

Recall different ROLES in 2 types of Sentences:

- مُبتَدَأ[1] or Early Subject (before IS) : Noun-based Sentence or الْجُمْلَةُ الاسْمِيَّة
  Its **status normally** مَرْفُوعٌ or حرف النصب and its victim
  A stronger definition: (In term of meaning) **It is the Subject of the Sentence that appears before** (IS).

  Example: وَ ٱللَّهُ بَصِيرٌ بِٱلْعِبَادِ And Allah is seer of His slaves. 3:15 part

- خَبَرْ or Late Subject that appears after (IS): Its status is مَرْفُوعٌ .

- فَاعِل or Outside Doer: Verbal Sentence or الْجُمْلَةُ الفِعْلِيَّةُ
  Its **status normally** مَرْفُوعٌ
  A stronger definition: (In term of meaning) **it is the Doer of the Verb.**

  Example: وَ إِذْ تَأَذَّنَ رَبُّكُمْ And when your lord declares.. 14:7 part

[1] See Part 3 for details

Extra/Additional مِنْ: Important Note Cont.1

- Additional مِنْ will change the status of its next إِسْم to مَجْرُورٌ , BUT their **ROLES will be unchanged**.

Example:

With مِنْ i.e. Emphatic Version	Without مِنْ i.e. Normal Version
مَا لَهُ مِنْ قَلَمٍ Not **a single pen** (مُبْتَدَأ) is for him i.e. He does not have a single pen	مَا لَهُ قَلَمٌ Not **a pen** (مُبْتَدَأ) is for him, i.e. He does not have a pen
مَا فِي ٱلْبَيْتِ مِن رَّجُلٍ Not **a single man** (مُبْتَدَأ) is in the house. i.e. There is not a single man in the house	مَا فِي ٱلْبَيْتِ رَجُلٌ Not **a man** (مُبْتَدَأ) is in the house. i.e. There is no man in the house
مَا تَسْقُطُ مِن وَّرَقَةٍ Not **a single leaf** (فَاعِل) falls	مَا تَسْقُطُ وَرَقَةٌ No **leaf** (فَاعِل) falls

Test of Short-cut commands

وَ جَآءَتْ سَكْرَةُ ٱلْمَوْتِ بِٱلْحَقِّۚ

Next copy form tanzil.com/quran explorer (both are ok)

ٱلْحَمْدُ لِلَّهِ رَبِّ ٱلْعَٰلَمِينَ